

Ghaf Product Experience Redesign

Revised architecture and design direction for Parent and Child experiences

SMAC 2026 MVP PROTOTYPE | APPROVED DIRECTION | SEPTEMBER 2026

PRODUCT PROMISE

Ghaf helps children build positive routines through parent-approved tasks, child-safe AI support, Seeds, growing UAE landscapes, friendly family competition, and optional parent-funded rewards.

Recommended direction. Replace the former linear ten-screen demonstration with one application containing two separately authenticated experiences. This simplifies the daily journey while adding the authentication, Family Reward, and League capabilities required by the revised concept.

Prepared for design and implementation handoff.

Executive Summary

This brief recommends a unified Ghaf application with two separately authenticated Parent and Child experiences. The Parent experience centralizes task creation, confirmations, family management, Reward Plans, League membership, and permissions. The Child experience concentrates on daily tasks, Garden growth, and a fair, invite-only family League.

The League uses a normalized Weekly Growth Score based on five age-appropriate Challenge Leaves. Permanent Seeds, Garden progression, weekly competition, and optional private Family Rewards remain deliberately separate. The proposed reward and AI patterns include explicit child-safety, privacy, accessibility, and parental-control safeguards.

The visual system introduces bilingual Alexandria and Readex Pro typography, true right-to-left behavior, and a modern UAE botanical identity. Existing handoff documents must be revised before implementation because they conflict with this direction on child leaderboards, monetary rewards, role switching, and typography.

Decision Summary

Area	Approved direction
Architecture	One application with separately authenticated Parent and Child experiences.
Competition	A private Ghaf Family League with age-normalized weekly scoring and a cooperative family goal.
Rewards	Optional private Family Rewards set by parents and tied to personal progress, never League position.
AI	Task-focused, age-adaptive, bilingual support with parent controls and push-to-talk voice.
Design	A polished UAE botanical identity with purpose-built bilingual typography and role-appropriate expression.

IMPLEMENTATION PREREQUISITE

Update the existing handoff documents before Codex implementation begins.

1. Experience Architecture

Ghaf should replace the previous linear ten-screen demonstration with one application containing two separately authenticated experiences. Although authentication, Family Reward, and League capabilities are being added, the everyday journey for each user should become simpler and more focused.

The information architecture should target approximately 14 screen families, with each user seeing only the screens relevant to their role. The final count should be validated when the detailed screen inventory is prepared.

Navigation by Experience

Experience	Primary navigation	Contextual screens and controls
Parent	Home, Tasks, Garden, Family	Task Builder, Parent Task Check-in, Reward Plan, League and family-group management, pairing, permissions, and settings
Child	Today, Garden, League	Child access and pairing, profile, language and voice preferences, and AI permission status

Settings, device management, and permission controls should remain behind the profile avatar. Any permission change requiring parental authority must remain parent-gated.

Screens to Remove or Consolidate

1. Remove the repeated /role screen and all forced switching between Parent and Child experiences.
2. Combine welcome, language selection, and access choice into one entry screen.
3. Merge Create Task and Review Task into one guided Task Builder.
4. Present the reward celebration as a state within the Garden rather than as a permanent screen.
5. Replace the former Circle screen with the persistent Ghaf Family League.
6. Keep AI assistance within the relevant task or decision instead of creating a standalone chat tab.
7. Place settings, device management, and permissions behind the profile avatar.

Screens and Capabilities to Add

8. Dedicated Parent sign-in and setup.
9. Dedicated Child access and device pairing.

10. Parent-managed Reward Plans.
11. A Child-facing Ghaf Family League.
12. Parent-facing League and family-group management.
13. Child profile, language, voice, and AI permission controls.
14. Parent reauthentication for sensitive reward, membership, media, and permission changes.

2. Ghaf Family League

The Ghaf Family League should provide enough competition to feel engaging while remaining fair to children of different ages and abilities. Personal progression, weekly competition, and private rewards must remain separate systems.

System	Purpose
Seeds and Garden	Permanent personal growth
Weekly Growth Score	Friendly competition
Family Reward	Optional private reward established by the parent

At the beginning of each week, every child receives five age-appropriate Challenge Leaves.

WEEKLY SCORING

$$\text{Weekly Growth Score} = \text{confirmed Challenge Leaves} \div 5 \times 100$$

This normalized score allows, for example, a six-year-old and a twelve-year-old to compete fairly even when their tasks differ.

League Rules

15. Participation is limited to invited siblings and cousins.
16. The maximum Weekly Growth Score is 100.
17. Extra tasks may grow the Garden but cannot improve a child's League position beyond the weekly maximum.
18. Help and accessibility adaptations earn full credit.
19. Tied children share the same position; completion speed is never used as a tiebreaker.
20. Rankings reset each week, while earned Seeds and trees remain permanent.
21. Prayer, affection, emotional disclosure, and private wellbeing activities cannot be assigned as Challenge Leaves.

22. Children may see one another's nicknames, tree avatars, positions, scores, and completed Leaves. They must not see another child's tasks or evidence.
23. Children may send prepared bilingual encouragement, such as “Great growing!”, but cannot exchange unrestricted messages.
24. Every completed Challenge Leaf also contributes to a cooperative family-canopy goal.

Design Rationale

Research on competitive gamification is mixed. Competition may improve engagement, but its advantage over noncompetitive designs is not consistently robust. Ghaf should therefore combine visible weekly rankings with personal progression and a shared family outcome.

Supporting research: [Peer competition and collaboration meta-analysis](#)

3. Family Reward — المكافأة العائلية

The reward feature should be called Family Reward — المكافأة العائلية, rather than a wallet or cash store. It represents a private promise between a parent and child, not a currency system.

Example Reward Plans

Personal milestone	Example Family Reward
Earn 120 new eligible Seeds	AED 25
Grow the Mangrove from Sapling to Shade	AED 50
Grow three different landscapes to Sapling	A parent-selected reward

A Family Reward may be money, an experience, a privilege, or a gift. Eligible Seeds are Seeds earned through activities permitted to support a reward milestone; the excluded activity categories below never qualify.

REWARD LIFECYCLE

Promised → Unlocked → Given

Reward Safeguards and Operating Rules

25. The parent selects the amount or reward according to the family's circumstances.
26. The reward is visible only to the relevant child and their guardians.
27. Monetary values never appear in the League.

28. Rewards unlock through personal Seed or tree milestones, never by finishing first.
29. Every child can unlock their own reward regardless of League position.
30. Ghaf must not establish a universal Seed-to-AED exchange rate.
31. The application does not transfer, store, or take custody of money.
32. Once unlocked, a reward cannot be withdrawn as punishment.
33. Parents may change future Reward Plans but cannot retroactively change an agreed milestone.
34. Monetary rewards cannot be attached to prayer, affection, emotional disclosure, eating, or demonstrating love for relatives.
35. Praise and Garden growth must appear before any monetary-reward message.
36. Parents should see the maximum total amount they have promised for the month, helping prevent accidental overcommitment.

Design Rationale

This model reflects guidance favoring specific goals, clearly agreed rewards, positive recognition, the absence of demerits, and gradual reward fading.

Guidance: [American Academy of Pediatrics reward guidance](#)

Guidance: [CDC praise and reward guidance](#)

4. Authentication and Account Separation

Ghaf should remain one application while providing two genuinely distinct account experiences. Parent and Child access must not operate as a simple visual role switch.

Capability	Parent experience	Child experience
Primary access	Email or phone authentication	Parent-created avatar plus Child PIN or picture sequence on a shared device
Separate device	Approves the device pairing request	Scans a family QR code or enters a short pairing code
Identity requirement	Parent account	No child email address or phone number required
Security gate	Parent PIN, passkey, or biometric gate	Cannot enter the Parent experience through a tab or navigation control

Capability	Parent experience	Child experience
Permissions	Controls tasks, confirmations, children, Family Rewards, League membership, and AI permissions	Cannot edit Family Rewards, invite League members, or view Parent reports

Sensitive Changes Requiring Reauthentication

- 37. Creating or changing a monetary Family Reward.
- 38. Adding or removing family members or League participants.
- 39. Changing voice, media, or AI permissions.

PROTOTYPE BOUNDARY

For the SMAC 2026 prototype, these flows may use deterministic synthetic sign-ins while still looking and behaving like separate secure experiences.

5. Child AI Voice and Language

The Ghaf Coach should remain task-focused, with communication adapted to the child's age and level of independence.

Age group	Communication approach
6-8	Slower voice, one instruction at a time, very short sentences, and an early "Ask an adult" option
9-11	Two or three steps, a friendly explanation, and quick-choice responses
12-14	Respectful, concise, and mature language that never feels babyish

Arabic and Bilingual Language Approach

- 40. Use clear Modern Standard Arabic for task requirements, safety instructions, and sensitive content.
- 41. Use a light, parent-approved Emirati or Gulf conversational register for greetings and encouragement.
- 42. Understand natural Arabic-English code-switching.
- 43. Avoid exaggerated dialect, invented cultural expressions, or religious rulings.
- 44. Have Emirati parents, children, and language specialists review the final phrase and voice library.

Voice Interaction Controls

Voice interaction should be push-to-talk only and include:

45. A visible recording state.
46. A transcript with delete-before-send.
47. Replay, captions, and slower playback.
48. Persistent visibility of the current task.
49. A prominent “Ask an adult — اسأل شخصًا كبيرًا” action.

6. Bilingual Typography System

Ghaf should use the same two bilingual font families across its Arabic and English experiences:

50. **Alexandria** for titles, Garden and landscape names, and milestone moments. [View font](#)
51. **Readex Pro** for body copy, controls, tasks, AI dialogue, and League data. [View font](#)

Values below are shown as font size/line height, followed by font family and weight.

Element	Child experience	Parent experience
Hero heading	32/44, Alexandria 800	30/42, Alexandria 700
Screen title	26/38, Alexandria 700	24/36, Alexandria 700
Arabic body	18/30, Readex Pro 400–500	17/28, Readex Pro 400
Button	17/26, Readex Pro 600	16/24, Readex Pro 600
Caption	Minimum 14/22	Minimum 14/22

Implementation Requirements

52. Apply true page-level right-to-left behavior rather than manually reversing individual components.
53. Use more line height for Arabic than for English.
54. Do not apply artificial letter spacing to Arabic.
55. Avoid thin Arabic font weights.
56. Correctly handle mixed content such as AED 50, بذرة ١٢٠, and child names.
57. Use tabular numerals for rankings, Seeds, and Family Rewards.

- 58. Support font scaling without clipping labels or buttons.
- 59. Fully localize each screen rather than displaying Arabic and English simultaneously throughout the interface.

7. Visual Design Direction

The Parent experience should feel calm, premium, and highly organized. The Child experience may be brighter and more expressive, with larger controls and stronger landscape moments, but it should remain polished rather than cartoonish.

Shared Visual Principles

- 60. A modern UAE botanical identity.
- 61. Strong bilingual typography.
- 62. Clean surfaces with limited card stacking.
- 63. Purposeful illustration rather than generic UAE ornament.
- 64. Restrained, meaningful animation.
- 65. A clear hierarchy with one dominant action per screen.

EXPERIENCE BALANCE

Parent: calm, premium, organized.
Child: brighter, expressive, polished.
Shared: unmistakably Ghaf.

8. Handoff Implications and Next Step

These decisions conflict with parts of the current handoff documentation, which prohibit child leaderboards and monetary rewards and continue to specify role switching and system typography. Those documents should be revised before implementation begins.

Next Design Deliverable

Convert this approved direction into:

- 66. One Google Stitch master prompt.
- 67. Focused prompts for each Parent screen.
- 68. Focused prompts for each Child screen.
- 69. Dedicated authentication, League, and Family Reward prompts.

REQUIRED SEQUENCE

Revise the handoff documents first; then prepare the Google Stitch prompt set; then begin Codex implementation.

References

70. [Peer competition and collaboration meta-analysis](#). Supporting research for combining competition with personal and cooperative goals
71. [American Academy of Pediatrics: Positive Reinforcement Through Rewards](#). Reward-planning guidance
72. [CDC: Using Rewards](#). Praise and reward guidance
73. [Alexandria typeface](#). Recommended bilingual display family
74. [Readex Pro typeface](#). Recommended bilingual text and interface family

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